

The STANDARD

*To Know Him
And
To Make Him Known*

May 1994

SOLDIERS OR "SOFTIES?"

In the words of Issac Watt's hymn, "Am I a Soldier of the Cross?," stanza two asks this question:

Must I be carried to the skies
On flowery beds of ease,
While others fought to win the
prize

And sailed thro' bloody seas?"
Are we losing heart? What's happened to our tenacity? Where are those who are willing to "fight the good fight of faith?"

It's never easy--it never has been nor will it ever be. But it is always right to fight for what is right!

How quickly we forget! It appears that many in America, and especially those in places of leadership, have conveniently developed spiritual amnesia. Old Testament prophets, the Apostles, Jesus, Martin Luther, John Bunyan, all paid the price for fighting for what is right!

I love young people. I love young preachers and pastors. I have always tried to help them and promote them. But I must confess, I am deeply bothered by what I am hearing from the next generation of potential leaders.

Have we lost our nerve? I just don't understand the statement, "I'm tired of fighting the battles. I'm tired of the fussing and fighting."

From what are we tired? It's certainly not from fighting. Our uniforms are too clean.

Certainly there is no use to fight just to be fighting. But there must always be those who are contending for the faith. Believe me, I understand the weariness and tiredness, but we can never grow so weary and get so tired that we quit. If God will be my helper, I'm just as determined to fight sin at 46 as I was at 26! I hope I'm a little wiser, but the battle never ends!

I think some have allowed the principle of fighting to grow fuzzy in their minds. I think the episode of David fighting Goliath can help us a bit.

I don't believe David set out on his journey to find his brothers and deliver to them a few vittles with an arrogant, haughty, "macho" attitude. In fact, when Goliath stepped out on the hillside, I cannot imagine David feeling like a "macho man!"

But wait a minute! There was something at stake here. It wasn't right for Goliath to blaspheme the name of Jehovah God and get by. Something had to be done. I submit

to you that David did not fight just because he wanted to, but rather he entered the fight because it was right to defend the cause. There is a cause at stake! We must defend the honor of our God. We must defend the integrity of righteousness!

I challenge all of us--young and old--to get back in the battle. There may be a time when each of us need a little spiritual "R & R." But we dare not stay away from the battle front too long.

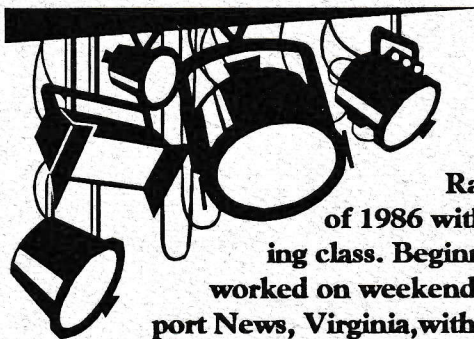
It is not necessary that we win every battle, but it is necessary that we fight!

Paul wrote to young Timothy in II Tim. 2:3, "Thou therefore endure hardness, as a good soldier of Jesus Christ." May all of us become real soldiers of the cross. Are you a soldier or a "softie?"

Sure I must fight, if I would reign
Increase my courage Lord;
I'll bear the toil, endure the pain
Supported by Thy Word."

"Am I A Soldier of the Cross"
Isaac Watts





ALUMNI SPOTLIGHT

Randall Owens graduated in May of 1986 with Southeastern's second graduating class. Beginning in January of that year, he worked on weekends at First FWB Church in Newport News, Virginia, with Rev. Tag Kilgore. After graduation, he immediately began full-time working with the teens and also in Peninsula Christian School. In 1988, Randall worked exclusively with the church in the youth and bus ministries and has continued to do so until about a year ago when he became the assistant pastor to focus primarily in the areas of education and evangelism. Now he oversees the Sunday School, Discipleship Training, Evangelism Explosion, and a young married couples class.

In December of '87, Randall married Amber Davenport at First Church in Newport News. In June of '92 their first child, Abigail, was born who will be two next month.



MISSENS STUDENTS SERVE THIS SUMMER

We are privileged to have two Southeastern students ministering as summer missionaries. It is our desire that you will pray for them as they work for the Lord in different cultures. This opportunity will give them on the job training and help them to know more about missions and the great doors that are opened to us at this time.

Genell Boyce will be ministering in Japan with missionary Debbie Griffin. Her work will be with Japanese students and helping Miss Griffin in any way possible.

Sherri Howell will be in the country of Uruguay with Dave and Becky Franks. She will be assisting with the youth ministry.

PROSPECTIVE STUDENTS CALL TODAY FOR YOUR APPLICATION PACKET



Marc

MOST OUTSTANDING STUDENTS

Congratulations are extended to Marc A. Holloman and Edward Keith Owens who were chosen as Southeastern's 1994 Most Outstanding Students.



Keith

The recipients of this award are chosen based on their academic achievement, social interaction, willingness to serve, student leadership and Christian testimony.

PROFESSOR NEEDED

Southeastern is in need of a professor in the area of business/accounting. If interested, please send a resume to:

Southeastern
PO Box 1700
Wendell, NC 27591

CONGRATULATIONS, GRADUATES



Con-
gratulations
to twenty
graduates
who partici-
pated in the
1994 com-

mencement exercises held May 12. Special recognition was awarded to Robert Ellis (Christian Service Award) and to Marc Holloman and Keith Owens (Most Outstanding Students). Marc Holloman was also presented the Outstanding Academic Achievement award for maintaining a 4.0 GPA throughout his four years at Southeastern. Miss Frances Zimmer was also honored for her two years as an instructor in the Business Department.

Commencement speaker, Rev. Dann Patrick, challenged the graduates from Solomon's admonition regarding "work" (Proverbs 6:6) using fascinating analogies between the "nature of the ant" and the productivity of a dedicated Christian.

Special music was provided by the Southeastern Choir and by two graduating seniors, Keith Owens and Lange Patrick.

Along with family and friends, we congratulate the seniors and pray that God will richly bless them in their labor for Him.

1994 GRADUATES

Bachelor Degree in Bible
Hector Adrian Alonso, Jr.
Johnathan Brian Keen

Bachelor Degree
in Biblical Studies
*Michael Wayne Ayers***

Bachelor Degree in
Christian Education
Susan Rena Alonso
Angela Beth Ballard
Jennifer Lynn Chenault
*Michael Joseph Fulcher***
*Marc A. Holloman**
*Thack Kam Yin Jacobs***
Melissa Jones
Amy Elizabeth Mainus
*Edward Keith Owens****
*Jefferson Lange Patrick****
Shara LaMay Scott
Anita Marie Wilt

Bachelor Degree
in Sacred Music
Joy E. Adney
Samuel David Harris
Dennis Ray Jones, Jr.

Christian School
of Business Degree
Allison Lee Hart
Tracy Leigh Johnson

**Summa Cum Laude*
***Magna Cum Laude*
****Cum Laude*

A TRIBUTE

TO

RANDY SAWYER

A college has many components that form its identity. Not the least of which is its faculty. Southeastern has been blessed with a faculty and staff that have shaped its initial identity with characteristics such as sacrifice, ability, talent, hard work, and flexibility. Randy Sawyer has certainly contributed enormously in these areas as well as others. After nine years of service, Mr. Sawyer is returning to a local church ministry at First FWB Church, Gastonia, NC. He is presently serving as Associate Pastor under Rev. William Calvert, the long time pastor of the church.

Mr. Sawyer assumed the task of defining the music program of Southeastern College in its early years and along with Mrs. Terri Siebert's expertise, the program stands as a model to follow. Southeastern's music is widely appreciated and our students have been well trained. Dr. Lee Roberson commented at our tenth anniversary Evangelism Conference, that the music was as good as he had heard anywhere.

Mr. Sawyer has also taught Bible courses and homiletics. Anyone who has heard him preach knows that he is a student of the Word and an able preacher of it as well. He is widely sought as a revival and conference speaker.

With mixed emotions, we say goodbye to Randy. We will miss him but wish God's blessing on his new ministry.



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Prospective Students...



Things are really going well this spring in recruitment as we look forward to a great fall. At present we have 44 applications on hand from new students which is an increase of 60% over this time last year. We anticipate many more students to apply in the next few months! One of the most encouraging signs is that we are getting students from new churches. Our recruiting efforts from choir tour have yielded five new students for next year.

If you know of someone who has not yet applied, please encourage them to get their information in as soon as possible. I hope you will feel free to call my office if I can be of any assistance.

Conference Recap

The 1994 Conference on Revival and Soul Winning has come and gone but will long be remembered as one of our best.

All of the speakers did an outstanding job - from Jerry Johnson's sermon about "Clouds" to Roy Thomas' reminder of our use and love of the Kings James Version of the Bible. We heard admonitions from the hearts of great men of God regarding our preaching, soul winning, and building the church.

As well as hearing some fine preaching, we also were blessed with outstanding music and testimonies from students at Southeastern.

One of the highlights of the

meeting was on Tuesday evening when over two dozen alumni joined our choir to sing to the praise and glory of God.

The most striking aspect of the conference, however, was the sweet and encouraging spirit that prevailed. Many have commented on how refreshing the services were saying that it was the best spirit we have had in years.

In fact, with the announcement of the successful refinancing of our long term debt and the report of a record number of new student applications, we all went away with a new optimism regarding the future of Southeastern.

SPECIAL THANKS...

To the Patch the Pirate Club at Shady Grove FWB Church, Durham, NC for their recent contribution of \$45 to Southeastern.

To Rufus Coffey for his recent donation of books to Southeastern's library.